MCP

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So You Want to Date a Superhero

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SO YOU WANT TO DATE A SUPERHERO?

CHARACTERS

Announcer	Male or Female.
Taylor Williamson	Game show host. Male or Female.
Dana	Super hero. Looking for a date. Female
Steve	Contestant. Male.
Trevor	Contestant. Male.
Ryanne	Contestant. Mousy. Female.

SET

Can be a bare stage. Needs at least a divider of some type between Dana and the contestants. Taylor could have a podium, but not necessary. Should have the feel of a dating game set-up.

AUTHOR'S NOTE

The key to this show will be facial reactions from the various actors. It is important that Ryanne be as one-note as possible.

SO YOU WANT TO DATE A SUPERHERO?

(Lights come up. DANA sits CS; STEVE, TREVOR, RYANNE sit SL. TAYLOR is SR.)

ANNOUNCER

It's time, once again, for everyone's favorite dating show (alone or with audience) "So You Want to Date a SuperHero"! And here's your host, Taylor Williamson!

TAYLOR

I am your host, Taylor Williamson. Today we have on the show Princess Diana, oh wait, sorry, Dana. Dana?

DANA

It's Dana. A common mistake.

TAYLOR

For a second I thought you were…

DANA

No.

TAYLOR

But you sort of look like…

DANA

It's Dana. Princess Dana.

TAYLOR

Right you are. And where are you from, Dana?

DANA

Themyscira. (*Beat.*) Indiana.

TAYLOR

There's a Themyscira, Indiana?

DANA

Yes.

TAYLOR

Really?

DANA

Look, there's an Olympia Washington, a Sparta Georgia….

TAYLOR

Ok, Ok, We get it. What sort of date will our lovebirds be going on?

ANNOUNCER

Taylor, our newly branded couple will be eating dinner at a lovely little diner in Hell's Kitchen, situated nicely in the middle of a ninja training facility, a secret, government black site for extremely dangerous villains, a radioactive insect and animal lab, and finally a newly opened cupcake shop.

TAYLOR

Fantastic. Let's meet our contestants. Contestant one?

STEVE

Hi Taylor! My name is Steve.

TAYLOR

Steve, I really like your energy, you seem pretty excited.

STEVE

I'm over the bar scene and going home with a different woman every single night. I'm ready to settle and find true love. And if she's a millionaire super hero, all the better.

TAYLOR

Whoah, have a hard time affording breakfast for two there Steve?

STEVE

I've never had one stay for breakfast, they always sneak out in the middle of the night. Usually with my watch. Or wallet. (*Emotional.*) One time my dog.

TREVOR

(*Reaching over and putting hand on Steve's shoulder.*)

I've been there, man. I've been there.

TAYLOR

(Long Pause.)

Well, umm, let's go straight to contestant three.

RYANNE

Hi, Taylor. And just for the record, I've never stolen anyone's dog. Or wallet.

TREVOR

He also said watch.

RYANNE

I heard.

(Pause.)

TAYLOR

So, Ryanne, you are a girl.

RYANNE

Yes.

TAYLOR

I feel as if our producers thought you were a boy.

RYANNE

Because of my name?

TREVOR

I was wondering why a chick was sitting there.

STEVE

I thought this was one of those new shows that rejects the gender normative standards of the past.

TREVOR

Oh.

TAYLOR

Dana, you ok with Ryanne being here?

DANA

I'm not going to alienate an entire fan base, so I'm cool with that.

TAYLOR

Great. And contestant number two.

TREVOR

Trevor.

TAYLOR

Ok, now let's…

TREVOR

Uh, I have a quick question.

TAYLOR

Ok, Trevor.

TREVOR

Can we get a quick rundown of what we are dealing with, in terms of powers here? Am I safe? And she isn't one of those wake up with nightmares and like stab me in my chest accidentally types?

STEVE

Tortured hero, right. I would also like to hear that. Yes. And any sort of weapons she may have. Swords. Guns. Electric billy clubs. Fusion weapons that could explode me if I were caught cheating or lying. Things like that.

TREVOR

Does she have powers where she can't touch anyone or they die?

STEVE

I need hugs.

TAYLOR

Great questions. Dana?

DANA

I am optimistic. I've been told annoyingly optimistic at times. Not tortured. Yet. I have super strength. Pretty strong. I've never accidentally stabbed anyone. And I can touch things.

TREVOR

What kind of things do you like to touch?

STEVE

Can you lift a car?

DANA

Easily. And the only weapon I really have is a lasso.

TREVOR

I could get on board with that.

STEVE

Yeah. Um, do you like tying things up…or…ummm….you know….

TREVOR

Being tied up?

STEVE

What Trevor said.

TAYLOR

Gentlemen, gentlemen. (*Pause.*) I kinda want to know now, too. Dana?

DANA

I like tying other people up with it…(*Steve and Trevor fist bump*)…because my lasso is magic and makes whoever is tied up with it tell the truth.

TREVOR

Well damn, Dana. That really does not sound like fun at all now.

STEVE

I knew there had to be a catch. Magic. Freaking magic.

TAYLOR

Ryanne? You've been pretty quiet.

RYANNE

I think honesty is important, and I like telling the truth.

TAYLOR

Dana, do you have a question for your potential dates?

DANA

Yes. In the past, the person I'm dating usually gets caught up in my adventures. Are you open to that? Being part of adventures?

TAYLOR

Great question. Let's start with Trevor.

TREVOR

Without a doubt. What would we be doing? Drinking wine under the setting sun in Tuscany?

DANA

Ok. Here's a typical situation. I am fighting fifty bad guys with my sword and shield…

TREVOR

I thought you just had a lasso?

DANA

And a sword. And a shield. And sometimes my tiara can act like a boomerang.

STEVE

You sound violent.

DANA

So, inevitably, I lose my sword in the middle of the battlefield, but I need my sword in order to defeat the boss.

TAYLOR

Obviously.

DANA

Are you willing to run out into the battlefield, grab the sword, and throw it to me just as you are being knocked out or taken out by aforementioned bad guys?

TREVOR

What sort of weapons do the bad guys have?

DANA

AMP-69's firing 7.62x39mm cartridges with a few Barrett REC7's firing the 6.8mm Remington special thrown in to make things interesting.

STEVE

(*Giggles*)

She said "69".

TREVOR

And I have to run out, grab your sword? And then what, run it over to you?

DANA

It's more dramatic if you throw it, like in an arc.

TAYLOR

Do you not watch any superhero movies, Trevor? Dana, will you also be requiring the AAAAAAAAAAUGH noise whilst he is throwing.

DANA

Of course. I like it when my man giving me the sword is vocal. The louder the better.

RYANNE

Man?

DANA

Person.

STEVE

If I can interject here for a moment. Can bullets hurt you, Dana?

DANA

No.

STEVE

Then why don't you just go out and grab your sword?

DANA

That undercuts the moment, Steve. Someone who can die needs to do it, to inspire me.

RYANNE

I'd inspire you.

TREVOR

So I just do all of that, risk my life to inspire you?

DANA

For that particular moment, yes. Heroes need inspiration, otherwise we would just sit around all day in our pajamas eating ice cream and watching Judge Joe Brown [*Feel free to change Judge Joe Brown to any judge or talk show. Region-specific is best.*]

RYANNE

I love that show.

STEVE

Pajamas? Are they silky?

TREVOR

So, I just need to risk my life? I'll be safe?

TAYLOR

(Grimaces) You need to catch up on your Netflix.

DANA

Well, if you actually die, flinging me the sword with your last breath? That would be fantastic. Especially if we had eye contact as the bullets exploded through your body. Do you think that could happen?

TREVOR

Wait, what?

STEVE

You want us to die?

DANA

I don't *want* you to die. But that's the whole point of being my romantic interest.

TREVOR

Taylor, what the hell is going on here? Is this like the Purge, or a dating show?

TAYLOR
Absolutely a dating show. But she's a super hero. That's the show. And there are expectations.

STEVE
Hold the door open. Hold the umbrella. Hold in the fart. Those are dating expectations.

TAYLOR
If you don't have powers and are the romantic interest of a super-hero….you are going to die.

DANA
To provide inspiration. You die reminding me to keep fighting for the regular people.

RYANNE
That sounds very noble.

STEVE
You are out of your mind.

DANA
My last romantic interest died a hundred years ago. That's why I need renewed inspiration.

TREVOR
WHAT?

DANA
In a plane explosion.

TAYLOR
Tragic.

RYANNE
Did he throw you your sword?

DANA
No, but he saved many lives. Very heroic.

STEVE
Hold on. Just. We have two things going on here.

TREVOR
One hundred years ago? How old are you?

DANA
Two thousand two hundred and twenty-nine.

STEVE
Taylor, is she all shriveled? I can't do all shriveled. Dana, you better not be bald.

RYANNE

I don't care.

TAYLOR

She is looking great from where I'm standing.

TREVOR

How many boyfriends have you had?

DANA

Boyfriends? Just the one.

STEVE

So one hundred percent of your boyfriends have died fiery deaths?

DANA

Yes.

TREVOR

And this happened one hundred years ago?

DANA

Yes. It took a long time to move on.

TREVOR

And you want us to die so you can be inspired?

DANA

No! Again. I don't *want* you to die. That's just the way things have to go. You seem very opposed to this idea of dying a long, torturous death.

TREVOR

Torturous?

DANA

The more cruel and painful the death, the more inspiring it is. That only makes sense.

TREVOR

I'm tapping out.

TAYLOR

Oh, too bad, Thanks for playing, Trevor. Steve, still in?

STEVE

I'm not out yet. She sounds hot. And, I'm guessing that it's better if we know each other a long time, so she can get really attached to me, and *then* I die?

DANA
Yes. The deeper I fall in love, the better.

STEVE
So, I'm gonna gamble here. Date her for six months, then break up. Free and clear.

TREVOR
I didn't think of that, I'm back in.

TAYLOR
Ouch, you didn't read the fine print, Steve.

STEVE
Fine print?

DANA
An ex is the one who is kidnapped, beaten, and tortured in a bid to get me to give up whatever the bad guys need to complete their plan. I feel guilty, so I have to come and rescue you.

STEVE
Oh.

TREVOR
And I'm back out!

STEVE
But, I don't die?

DANA
No, of course not. I'm a hero. I always save the kidnapped person right *before* they die.

STEVE
You sound pretty hot. It might be worth being kidnapped to be with you for six months.

TAYLOR
I feel I have to point out, Steve, that you will probably be kidnapped multiple times over the course of your life.

STEVE
I'm still in. I'm an instant gratification sort of guy.

TAYLOR
Ryanne, as usual, you've been pretty quiet this entire time. As if you have no personality at all and are just sort of existing. Is it for a particular purpose? We don't know yet. Are you still in? Remember death is on the table here.

RYANNE

I'm in. I think that having the entire purpose of one's life to be to die just to serve as an inspiration for a hero for a bit is a life well-lived.

TAYLOR

Interesting life philosophy there, Ryanne. What do you do for work?

RYANNE

I'm in refrigeration, actually.

TAYLOR

Really? Odd choice. Good pay?

RYANNE

I just love refrigerators.

TAYLOR

Who doesn't? Ok, Dana. We are down to Steve and Ryanne. Trevor is out.

TREVOR

Hold on…totally spaced an important question: What's your costume like?

DANA

Ummm, like really high boots, super short skirt, and my top sort of is like an armored corset.

TREVOR

Yeah, I'm back in.

TAYLOR

Welcome back. Dana?

DANA

Well, I like Steve's plan to break up with me after six months. I've never had an ex to save from being kidnapped, and that sounds like fun. I think I'd like the whole "I miss you, but we can never be together" speech after I rescue him. Lots of good drama there.

STEVE

Yes!

DANA

But, I am a little worried I won't really fall deeply in love with him if I know his plan.

TAYLOR

Good point.

DANA

I feel like Trevor is more the person who I have a one night stand with, and wake up to an empty bed, and learn a harsh lesson about all that is wrong with men. Sort of like a challenge to my normally sunny, optimistic disposition. But I overcome it, and choose to focus on the good I see.

TREVOR

I'm comfortable with that role in your life.

DANA

I feel like I can find that anywhere though. Men are mostly dirty pig boys.

TREVOR

Not true! Not true. I can promise you to sneak out in the middle of the night. And never contact you again. A lot of guys will say that, but then a month later they are texting you all like, "what's up" or pretending they are texting someone else "don't forget to pick up the bread", you know?

STEVE

That's true.

TAYLOR

Good point. Dana?

DANA

I'm sorry, Trevor. I am not picking you today.

TAYLOR

Steve or Ryanne?

STEVE

I'd love to be kidnapped. You've never had that experience. Here's your chance.

DANA

I'm going to go with Ryanne, actually.

RYANNE

Yes!

TAYLOR

Surprising choice. You went with the one-dimensional character.

DANA

She only has one purpose for existing, so I think that will work out great.

TAYLOR

Can't argue with that logic. (*Dana and Ryanne come front to hug and talk soto. Trevor and Steve talk soto. To Audience*.) Tune in next week when we have a new super-hero, he's tortured, he's dramatic, he's (*pause*) blind? (*Taylor turns to talk to Dana and Ryanne*.)

FADEOUT